

PROMPT DNA · FIELD GUIDE

Character Prompting Guide

A clean system for keeping one character recognizable across stills, scenes, videos, and generations.

Identity first. Direction second.

The core idea: separate identity from direction

Character consistency improves when identity is locked once, then reused as a reference. Keep the face and body in the image reference. Use text to control only scene, camera, movement, and mood. This separation reduces conflicting instructions—the reference says who the character is; the prompt says what happens.

Layer	What it controls
Identity Reference	Face geometry, proportions, hair, skin undertone, signature marks
Scene Prompt	Location, wardrobe, lighting temperature, time of day, narrative context
Motion Prompt	Camera trajectory, physical gesture, pacing, kinetics, micro-expression

Step 1 — Build the Master Identity Block

Start with one clear reference image. Extract only observable features and write them as a compact identity block you can reuse unchanged. Treat the description as a practical visual record, not as biometric certainty.

- 01 Facial structure.** Face shape, jaw angle, chin, cheekbones.
- 02 Eye and nose geometry.** Eye shape, spacing, tilt, iris color, bridge width, lip proportions.
- 03 Asymmetric anchors.** At least three distinctive marks such as a scar, mole, brow irregularity, or unusual hairline.
- 04 Skin and hair.** Skin type and undertone, pore texture, curl pattern, strand thickness, hairline.
- 05 Wardrobe signature.** Fabric, collar, weight, and color when clothing is part of the identity.

Copyable prompt

Use this prompt with a reference image in your image-analysis model:

```
You are a precision character-reference decompiler.  
Describe only observable, repeatable features. Avoid  
subjective appearance adjectives. Record cranial structure;  
facial and mandibular structure, including mandibular  
angle; ocular and nasal geometry; at least three asymmetric  
micro-anchors; Fitzpatrick skin type, undertone, and pore  
texture; curl type, strand thickness, and hairline; and  
wardrobe textile, GSM, construction, and color details when  
clothing is part of the identity. Return one concise comma-  
separated block labeled MASTER_IDENTITY_BLOCK.
```

Keep the result stable. Edit it only when you intentionally redesign the character. The value comes from preserving the same identity language across generations, not from making each description more elaborate.

Step 2 — Create Four Neutral Anchors

Before generating story scenes, create a clean reference set on a neutral matte-grey background with flat, even daylight. A neutral set keeps lighting and environment from being fused into the character during later generations.

File	View and Purpose
Anchor_Front.png	Front portrait: eye spacing, nose width, jawline
Anchor_3Q.png	45-degree view: cheekbone depth, brow depth, facial volume
Anchor_Side.png	90-degree profile: nose curvature, chin projection, forehead and neck line
Anchor_Full.png	Full-length neutral stance: proportions, posture, and wardrobe silhouette

Reference conditions. Neutral expression, closed mouth, direct gaze, minimal shadows, plain background. Dramatic lighting, busy environments, props, and expressive action belong in later generations.

Copyable turnaround prompt

Paste the Master Identity Block, then add:

Full orthographic character turnaround study showing a frontal eye-level portrait, a 45-degree three-quarter view, a 90-degree lateral profile, and a full-length neutral standing stance with arms relaxed at the sides. Neutral facial expression, mouth closed, direct gaze. Uniform 18% neutral matte-grey background. Flat diffuse 5500K daylight. Zero cast shadows. Clean reference sheet, consistent scale and framing.

Do not add dramatic lighting, busy environments, props, or expressive action to this reference image. The turnaround is a measurement aid: it should make face shape, volume, profile relationships, proportions and wardrobe silhouette easy to compare.

Save the four views as Anchor_Front.png, Anchor_3Q.png, Anchor_Side.png, and Anchor_Full.png.

Step 3 — Generate still images

For stills, combine the identity block with the appropriate anchor and the new scene. Keep identity language consistent while changing only the story variables.

Keep fixed	Change deliberately
Master Identity Block, anchor, defining marks	Location, action, wardrobe, lighting, lens, time of day

Still-image formula: [ANCHOR IMAGE] + [MASTER_IDENTITY_BLOCK] + [SCENE ACTION & LOCATION] + [WARDROBE] + [LIGHTING & LENS] + [ASPECT RATIO]

Midjourney:

```
[MASTER_IDENTITY_BLOCK], [SCENE ACTION AND LOCATION],  
cinematic 35mm photograph --cref [ANCHOR_FRONT_URL] --cw  
100 --ar 16:9
```

FLUX-style:

A cinematic 35mm portrait featuring
[MASTER_IDENTITY_BLOCK]. The character is [ACTION] in
[LOCATION], with [LIGHTING], [LENS], and [MOOD]. Preserve
the exact facial structure and asymmetric identity marks
from the reference image.

Weighting. Use `--cw 100` for maximum character carryover. Lower it toward `--cw 20` when changing clothing while retaining the face.

Step 4 — Direct video without face drift

When an image reference is attached, let the image define who the character is. Let the text define what happens. This decoupled rule applies to Runway, Kling, Veo, and LTX.

Image reference	Text prompt
Front or three-quarter anchor	Camera angle, subject movement, mood, pacing, physical action

Video formula: [SHOT SIZE & LENS] + [CAMERA TRAJECTORY] + [SUBJECT KINETICS & GESTURE] + [EMOTIONAL STATE] + [CADENCE / FPS]

Use this rule. Do not repeat hair, face, age, skin, or clothing details in the video text when the reference image already shows them. Conflicting descriptions can cause flicker, warping, or identity drift.

Copyable video prompt

```
[SHOT SIZE & LENS]. Subject executes [PHYSICAL ACTION & GESTURE], accompanied by [MICRO-EXPRESSION & EYELINE SHIFT]. Camera executes [CAMERA TRAJECTORY & SPEED]. Atmospheric [LIGHTING & MOOD], steady [CADENCE / FPS] film cadence, natural physical velocity.
```

Use the reference as the identity source. Keep the motion description focused on shot size and lens, physical action and gesture, micro-expression and eyeline, camera trajectory and speed, lighting and mood, and cadence / FPS.

Video motion templates

Attach **Anchor_Front.png** or **Anchor_3Q.png** in the image-reference slot. In the text box, describe only camera angle, movement, mood, and pacing.

Subtle reaction. Medium close-up, 85mm lens. Subject remains centered and turns the head 20 degrees toward the light source. Brow furrows slightly, lips part with a subtle breath, natural blink. Slow steady push-in, 24fps film cadence.

Entering a room. Wide tracking shot, 35mm lens. Subject walks forward through the doorway, right shoulder leading. Hand reaches to grip the doorframe, weight shifts naturally. Camera tracks backward smoothly at walking speed.

Conversation listening. Medium two-shot, 50mm lens. Subject listens without speaking, eyes shift briefly toward the other person, one small nod, relaxed breathing. Camera holds steady with a very slow lateral drift.

Dramatic look. Close-up, 50mm prime. Subject snaps their gaze from lower left directly to the camera lens. Jaw tightens, chest breathing remains shallow. Subtle handheld micro-shake, tense atmosphere.

Walking past camera. Full-body tracking shot, 35mm lens. Subject walks from background to foreground and passes camera on the left. Natural arm swing and weight transfer. Camera pans smoothly to maintain the subject in frame.

Consistency rules that hold up

- 01 Use the same identity block every time.
- 02 Choose the anchor that matches the camera angle.
- 03 Change one major variable at a time when testing.
- 04 Keep identity in the reference image and motion in the text.
- 05 Use simple backgrounds and stable lighting while validating the face.
- 06 Keep wardrobe separate from identity unless it is a signature element.
- 07 Save successful prompts, anchors, settings, and outputs together.

If the face drifts: return to the neutral front or three-quarter anchor, remove extra appearance words, simplify the action, shorten the shot, and test again before adding complexity.